Nine Governor Races Make History Across the Country

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Voters in nine states made history on Tuesday with their choices for **governor**, electing a string of firsts across the country.

In Georgia, Democrat Keisha Lance Bottoms will become the country's first Black woman elected **governor** of any state. The former Atlanta mayor, who served as an **adviser** to former President Joe Biden, **defeated** Republican Rick Jackson and became the first Democrat to win a Georgia **governor**'s race in more than two decades.

In New Mexico, Democrat Deb Haaland, who is of Pueblo Indian descent, will be the first Native American woman **governor** in U.S. history. Haaland, who **defeated** Republican Gregg Hull, had already made history as one of the first Native American women elected to Congress and as the first Native American Cabinet secretary.

California and Texas also elected Latino firsts. Democrat Xavier Becerra will be California's first elected Latino **governor**, succeeding **Governor** Gavin Newsom after defeating Republican Steve Hilton. Democrat Gina Hinojosa will be Texas's first Latina **governor**, defeating **incumbent** Republican **Governor** Greg Abbott and becoming the state's first Democratic **governor** in more than 30 years.

Florida and Wisconsin elected their first Black **governors**: Republican Byron Donalds in Florida, who beat Democrat David Jolly, and Democrat David Crowley in Wisconsin, who beat Republican Congressman Tom Tiffany.

Three more women made history. Republican **Senator** Marsha Blackburn became the first woman to win a **governor**'s race in Tennessee. Democrat Amy Klobuchar will become Minnesota's first woman **governor**. And in one of the night's bigger upsets, Democrat Amy Acton is set to become Ohio's first woman elected **governor** and the state's first Jewish **governor**, defeating Republican Vivek Ramaswamy.

From coast to coast, Tuesday's **governor** races redrew the map of who can hold a state's top job.

Word Treasure

governor -- The elected leader of a U.S. state, similar to a president but for one state.

incumbent -- A person who already holds a job or office and is trying to keep it in an election.

Senator -- A member of the Senate, one of the two chambers of Congress.

adviser -- A person who gives advice to a leader to help them make decisions.

defeated -- Beat someone in a contest or election; the defeated person lost.

Background you need

A governor leads a U.S. state, a bit like a president leads the whole country, running state services and signing state laws.

Governors are chosen in state elections, and many states had never before elected a woman, a Black leader or a Latino leader to the job.

Each governor's race is decided by voters in that state alone, which is why every state's 'first' is its own separate piece of history.

Break it down

LEAD: Nine states elect governors who are historic firsts

KEY EVENT: Tuesday's governor races across the country

+- WHO: Voters in Georgia, New Mexico, California, Texas, Florida, Wisconsin, Tennessee, Minnesota and Ohio

+- FIRSTS: First Black woman governor, first Native American woman governor, first Latino and Latina governors, first Black governors and first women governors

OPEN QUESTION: How these new governors will lead their states

Why it matters

Governors run state schools, roads and services, and these firsts widen the picture of who can hold a state's top job.

Test what you remember

1. How many states elected history-making governors?

(A) Twenty
(B) Five
(C) Nine
(D) Three

2. Who will become the country's first Black woman elected governor?

(A) Keisha Lance Bottoms
(B) Gina Hinojosa
(C) Deb Haaland
(D) Amy Klobuchar

3. Deb Haaland will be the first what?

(A) First Native American woman governor in U.S. history
(B) First woman governor of Tennessee
(C) First Black governor of Florida
(D) First Latina governor of Texas

4. Which state elected its first Latina governor?

(A) Wisconsin
(B) Texas
(C) New Mexico
(D) California

5. Who became the first woman to win a governor's race in Tennessee?

(A) Keisha Lance Bottoms
(B) Marsha Blackburn
(C) Amy Acton
(D) Amy Klobuchar

6. Amy Acton is set to become Ohio's first woman elected governor and also its first what?

(A) First Latino governor
(B) First Jewish governor
(C) First Black governor
(D) First Native American governor

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: A 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):